

Saturday, 27 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Light drizzle

32° 23°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

28° 18°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

29° 18°

GLASGOW

Drizzle

22° 17°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

A rapist who faked his own death and fled to Scotland has died in a US hospital.

Nicholas Rossi, who was arrested in a Glasgow hospital in 2021, died while awaiting extradition back to the UK. He had been trying to evade justice for his crimes.

CRIME · UK

2

A pilot has sadly died after a plane crash near an airfield.

Police confirmed the pilot, believed to be a woman in her 40s, was pronounced deceased at the scene. Investigations into the cause of the crash are now underway.

ACCIDENT · UK

3

Power banks and vapes are now the biggest fire risk on planes, according to new reports.

Lithium battery fires are a serious safety concern for aircraft, with the number of these devices found in hold bags almost doubling in the last year. Passengers are urged to be careful with their electronics.

SAFETY · UK

4

The Crown Estate's profits have fallen, with returns to the Treasury more than halving.

The main reason for the slump was reduced income from companies developing offshore wind farms. This impacts the funding available for public services.

ECONOMY · UK

5

It's been a day of big changes and mixed emotions for the Labour Party.

Andy Burnham was sworn in as MP for Makerfield, just hours after Keir Starmer announced his resignation as Labour Party leader. The party is now looking for a new leader.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

1

Missing Glastonbury this weekend? Don't worry, there's a festival on your doorstep!

Stars like Fatboy Slim and Becky Hill are playing small local venues across the country. It's all part of a celebration of the UK music scene, bringing the festival vibe closer to home.

ON AIR – What's the best local festival you've ever been to?

MUSIC · THIS WEEKEND

2

The new Spider-Noir series will let you choose between watching it in colour or black and white!

Starring Nicolas Cage, the show offers viewers a unique choice. It's an interesting way to experience the story and the character's world.

ON AIR – Would you watch a show in black and white just for the artistic choice?

TV · COMING SOON

3

DC Studios boss says the comics giant needs to win back fans' trust with their new 'Supergirl' film.

The latest release is part of a wider reset of their cinematic universe. They're hoping to learn from past mistakes and deliver something fans will love.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of the DC Universe, and what do you hope to see from 'Supergirl'?

FILM · COMING SOON

4

Canada could be eligible to join the Eurovision Song Contest!

Prime Minister Mark Carney raised the idea in his 2025 budget, sparking excitement among fans. Imagine Canada competing for the famous glass microphone!

ON AIR – Do you think Canada should be allowed to join Eurovision? Who would they send?

MUSIC · FUTURE

5

Could a Madison Square Garden wedding be the love story of Taylor Swift's wildest dreams?

Officials confirmed someone applied for a permit to close streets near the famous venue on July 4th. Speculation is rife about who might be tying the knot in such a grand style.

ON AIR – If you could get married anywhere, where would your 'wildest dreams' wedding venue be?

CELEBRITY · FUTURE

On the schedule

1

Ireland have stunned world champions India with a historic T20 win!

They pulled off a massive shock, beating India for the first time in Friday's opening T20 international in Belfast. What a result for Irish cricket!

ON AIR – What's the biggest sporting upset you've ever witnessed?

CRICKET · UK

2

Mercedes' Kimi Antonelli has topped Friday practice at the Austrian Grand Prix.

He headed McLaren's Oscar Piastri, showing strong pace ahead of the weekend's main event. It sets up an exciting race for Sunday.

ON AIR – Who are you backing for the win in Austria this weekend?

F1 · INTERNATIONAL

3

The FAW chief expects Craig Bellamy to remain Wales boss, despite his proposed move to Burnley collapsing.

Noel Mooney believes Bellamy will stay on as head coach. This will be welcome news for Welsh football fans.

ON AIR – Do you think it's a good thing for Wales that Bellamy is staying?

FOOTBALL · UK

4

Brentford are in talks to host Shakhtar's Champions League matches next season!

This means the London club could be playing host to European football's elite competition, even though they haven't qualified themselves. It would be a fantastic opportunity for the club.

ON AIR – Which European team would you love to see play at your local stadium?

FOOTBALL · UK

5

Former world champion Lizzie Deignan is returning to Great Britain's cycling team in a sporting director role.

She'll play a pivotal role in supporting the road squad at major events through to the LA 2028 Olympic Games. It's great to see her back in such an important position.

ON AIR – Who is your favourite British Olympian of all time?

CYCLING · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Gardeners are finding new joy in growing their own 'microgreens' indoors.**
These tiny, nutrient-packed plants can be grown on a windowsill, offering fresh flavour to meals year-round. It's a quick and rewarding way to add a bit of green to your plate.
- 2 The trend of 'silent discos' is moving beyond festivals and into everyday celebrations.**
People are hiring headphones for parties at home, allowing guests to choose their own music without disturbing the neighbours. It's a quiet revolution in party planning!
- 3 A surge in popularity for 'vintage fountain pens' is delighting calligraphy enthusiasts.**
Many are rediscovering the tactile pleasure of writing with a classic pen and ink. It's a charming nod to an elegant bygone era in our digital world.
- 4 More people are embracing the simple pleasure of 'picnic planning' with a modern twist.**
Beyond the traditional sandwiches, gourmet baskets with artisan cheeses and homemade treats are becoming the norm. It's about elevating an outdoor meal into a special occasion.
- 5 The art of 'patchwork quilting' is seeing a vibrant resurgence among craft lovers.**
People are creating beautiful, unique blankets and decor using fabric scraps. It's a wonderful way to recycle materials and create something truly personal.
- 6 The calming pastime of 'birdwatching' is attracting a new generation of enthusiasts.**
With more apps and online communities, identifying garden birds has never been easier. It's a peaceful way to connect with nature right on your doorstep.
- 7 Home bakers are experimenting with 'sourdough starters' at an unprecedented rate.**
The satisfaction of baking your own artisanal bread from scratch is proving irresistible. It's a delicious journey into the world of traditional baking.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with our houseplants, even though we know they can't understand us?

ANSWER: HAVING A LITTLE CHAT WITH THEM, ENCOURAGING THEM TO GROW!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'song' that we absolutely have to sing along to, no matter where we are?

ANSWER: BELTING OUT THAT FAVOURITE TUNE, OFTEN IN THE CAR!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you try a 'new tea or coffee' blend and it completely changes your morning routine for the better?**

Have you recently discovered a new brew that you now can't live without? What's your top recommendation for a perfect cuppa?

- **We all have those 'little rituals' we do before heading out for the day, don't we?**

What's that one thing you absolutely have to do before you leave the house – maybe it's checking your pockets three times, or always putting on your left shoe first?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood through the gills, and one circulates it to the rest of the body.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** A group of pugs is charmingly called a 'grumble'.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£9.52 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£9.52 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Penguins have an organ above their eyes that converts saltwater into freshwater.
- The Great Barrier Reef is the only living thing on Earth visible from space.
- The 'unicorn' is the national animal of Scotland.
- The world's oldest known piece of chewing gum is 9,000 years old.
- The average cloud weighs about 550 tons, roughly the same as 100 elephants.
- There are more possible chess game outcomes than there are atoms in the observable universe.
- A bolt of lightning is five times hotter than the surface of the sun.
- Strawberries are the only fruit with seeds on the outside.

On this day

Day 178 of the year, 187 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Arialdo; Christian feast day: Crescens, one of the Seventy disciples; Christian feast day: Cyril of Alexandria (Coptic Church, Roman Catholic Church, Anglican Communion and Lutheran Church); Christian feast day: Hemma of Gurk. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1962 — Michael Ball, English actor and singer
- 1945 — Joey Covington, American drummer, songwriter, and producer (died 2013)
- 1951 — Julia Duffy, American actress
- 1999 — Chandler Riggs, American actor
- 1986 — Drake Bell, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and actor
- 1997 — H.E.R., American singer-songwriter
- 1966 — J. J. Abrams, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1932 — Anna Moffo, American operatic soprano (died 2006)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1976 — Air France Flight 139 (Tel Aviv-Athens-Paris) is hijacked en route to Paris by the PFLP and redirected to Entebbe, Uganda.
- 1982 — Space Shuttle Columbia launched from the Kennedy Space Center on the final research and development flight mission, STS-4.
- 1988 — Villa Tunari massacre: Bolivian anti-narcotics police kill nine to 12 and injure over a hundred protesting coca-growing peasants.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2008 — In a highly scrutinized election, President of Zimbabwe Robert Mugabe is re-elected in a landslide after his opponent Morgan Tsvangirai had withdrawn a week earlier, citing violence against his party's supporters.
- 1982 — Space Shuttle Columbia launched from the Kennedy Space Center on the final research and development flight mission, STS-4.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2017 — A series of powerful cyberattacks using the Petya malware target websites of Ukrainian organizations and counterparts with Ukrainian connections around the globe.

- 1954 — The Obninsk Nuclear Power Plant, the Soviet Union's first nuclear power station, opens in Obninsk, near Moscow.
- 2013 — NASA launches the Interface Region Imaging Spectrograph space probe to observe the Sun.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 179 of the year, 186 days left in 2026. Today International LGBTQ Pride Day, marking the anniversary of Stonewall riots.; Christian feast day: Basilides and Potamiana; Christian feast day: Irenaeus of Lyon (Western Christianity); Christian feast day: Heimerad. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1948 — Kathy Bates, American actress
- 1969 — Tichina Arnold, American actress and singer
- 1945 — Ken Buchanan, Scottish boxer (died 2023)
- 1951 — Lalla Ward, English actress and author
- 1977 — Mark Stoermer, American bass player, songwriter, and producer
- 1946 — Bruce Davison, American actor and director
- 1966 — Bobby Bare Jr., American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1946 — Gilda Radner, American actress and comedian (died 1989)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2016 — A terrorist attack in Turkey's Istanbul Atatürk Airport kills 42 people and injures more than 230 others.
- 1997 — Holyfield–Tyson II: Mike Tyson is disqualified in the third round for biting a piece off Evander Holyfield's ear.
- 1964 — Malcolm X forms the Organization of Afro-American Unity.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1948 — Boxer Dick Turpin beats Vince Hawkins at Villa Park in Birmingham to become the first black British boxing champion in the modern era.
- 1981 — A powerful bomb explodes in Tehran, killing 73 officials of the Islamic Republican Party.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
		18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)